

Lesson: Origins of Storyboards

Visual storytelling has been around for thousands of years but the technique of storyboarding is a relatively new concept.

EARLY HISTORY OF THE STORYBOARD

In 1895 Auguste and Louis Lumière were credited with the first cinematic screening of moving pictures. Their film, "*L'Arrivée d'un Train À la Ciotat*" or "*Arrival of a Train at La Ciotat*", was nothing more than a shot of a train pulling into a station and then people getting off and boarding.

[Arrival of a Train at La Ciotat \(The Lumière Brothers, 1895\).mp4](#)

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Although the public was amazed the Lumières saw no future in it, using it only as a scientific method to record reality.

In 1902 George Méliès, a magician by trade, began using film to capture his magic tricks. He created elaborate sets for his films, the most well known of which is titled "*A Trip to the Moon*".

[A Trip to the Moon \(HQ 720p Full\) - Viaje a la Luna - Le Voyage dans la lune - Georges Méliès](#)

[1902.mp4](#) (<https://lynn.instructure.com/courses/27892/files/6478017/download?wrap=1>) ↓

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In 1914 - George McCay bet Ed McManus that he could bring a dinosaur to life. *Gertie the Dinosaur*

[Gertie the Dinosaur \(Winsor McCay, 1914\).mp4](#)

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1920's and 1930's, Max and Dave Fleischer created *Koko the Clown* and *Betty Boop*.

[OUT OF THE INKWELL- The Clown's Little Brother \(1920\) \(Remastered\) \(HD 1080p\).mp4](https://lynn.instructure.com/courses/27892/files/6478133/download?wrap=1)

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[The Origins of Betty Boop.mp4 \(https://lynn.instructure.com/courses/27892/files/6478108/download?](https://lynn.instructure.com/courses/27892/files/6478108/download?wrap=1)

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Up until this time animations consisted of only gags based around themes where the animators were responsible with creating the story ideas. Walt Disney, the father of the modern storyboard, created a story department which separated the animators from the story writers but both worked together to create the storyboards.

1920's, Walt Disney, Alice in Cartoonland series

[Walt Disney - 1925 - Alice the Toreador.mp4](https://lynn.instructure.com/courses/27892/files/6478055/download?wrap=1)

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May 15, 1928, Walt Disney, Plane Crazy

[Mickey Mouse- Plane Crazy \(1928\)..mp4](https://lynn.instructure.com/courses/27892/files/6478115/download?wrap=1)

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Soon after, Disney would revolutionize storyboarding into a system that is still used to this day.

